

0.0.1 To Ambattha

1. Thus was heard by me. At one time the Auspicious One was wandering on tour in Kosala with a large Saṅgha of bhikkhus, with about five hundred bhikkhus, when they arrived at a brahmin village of the Kosalans named Icchanangala. There the Auspicious One dwelled in the forest thicket of Icchanangala at Icchanangala.

2. At that time the brahmin Pokkharasati was reigning over Ukkattha, [a village] crowded with beings, with grass, food and water, a royal possession with grain, a gift to Brahmins, a royal gift given by king Pasenadi of Kosala. The brahmin Pokkharasati heard: “The good Gotama, son of the Sakyans,

ambatṭhasuttaṃ

evaṃ me¹ sutāṃ
ekāṃ samayaṃ bha-
gavā kosalesu cāri-
kaṃ caramāno ma-
hatā bhikkhusaṅ-
ghena saddhiṃ pañ-
camattehi bhikkhu-
satehi yena icchā-
naṅgalaṃ² nāma
kosalānaṃ brāhma-
ṇagāmo tadavasari.
tatra sudaṃ bha-
gavā icchānaṅgale³
viharati icchānaṅga-
lavanasaṇḍe.

tena kho pana sa-
mayena brāhmaṇo
pukkharasāti⁴ uk-
kaṭṭhaṃ ajjhāvasati
sattussadaṃ sati-
ṇakaṭṭhodakaṃ sa-
dhaññaṃ rājabhoga-
gaṃ rañña pasena-
dinā⁵ kosalena din-
naṃ rājadāyaṃ brah-
madeyyaṃ. assosi
kho brāhmaṇo pok-

having gone forth from the Sakyan clan, while wandering on tour in Kosala with a large Sangha of bhikkhus, with about five hundred bhikkhus, has arrived at Icchanangala and is dwelling in the forest thicket of Icchanangala at Icchanangala. Now a good reputation has been spread about that Auspicious Gotama thus: “Truly is he the Auspicious One, the Arahant, rightly self-awakened, excelling in knowledge and conduct, well-farer, knower of worlds, incomparable charioteer of tamed persons, teacher of devas and humans, awakened, auspicious.” Having realized this world with its devas, maras and brahmas, together with the population of samanas and brahmanas, devas and humans, he causes to make it known. He teaches the Dhamma that is good in the beginning, good in the middle, good in the end, with the right meaning and phras-

kharasāti: “samaṇo khalu bho gotamo sakyaputto sakyakulā pabbajito kosalesu cārikaṃ caramāno mahatā bhikkhusaṅghena sadhim pañcamattehi bhikkhusatehi icchānaṅgalaṃ anupatto icchānaṅgale viharati icchānaṅgalavanasaṇḍe. taṃ kho pana bhavantaṃ gotamaṃ evaṃ kalyāṇo kittisaddo abbhuggato: “itipi so bhagavā araham sammāsambuddho vijjācaraṇasampanno sugato lokavidū anuttaro purisadammasārathi⁶ satthā devamanussānaṃ buddho bhagavā.⁷ so imaṃ lokaṃ sadevakaṃ samāraṃ sabrahmakaṃ sasamaṇabrāhmaṇiṃ pajam sadevamanus-

ing, making known the life of purity that is utterly perfect and pure. Now good is the sight of such arahants.”

3. At that time there was the brahmin Pokkharasati's pupil, the brahmin youth Ambattha, a knowledge master of the three vedas, of the vocabularies and the rituals, of the phonology and the etymology with the legends as the fifth, master of the verses and the grammar, well versed in the materialistic philosophy and the auspicious marks of a great man. He was accepted and acknowledged by

saṃ sayamaṃ abhiññā sacchikatvā pave-
deti. so dhammaṃ
deseti ādikalyāṇaṃ
majjhekalyāṇaṃ pa-
riyosānakalyāṇaṃ
sāttamaṃ sabyañja-
naṃ⁸ kevalaparipuṇ-
ṇaṃ parisuddhaṃ
brahmacariyaṃ pa-
kāseti. sādhu kho
pana tathārūpānaṃ
arahataṃ dassanaṃ
hotī”ti.

tena kho pana sama-
yena brāhmaṇassa
pokkharasātissa am-
battho nāma mā-
ṇavo⁹ antevāsī hoti
ajjhāyako manta-
dharo tiṇṇaṃ vedā-
naṃ pāragū sani-
ghaṇḍukeṭubhānaṃ
sākkharappabhedā-
naṃ itihāsapañca-
mānaṃ padako vey-
yākaraṇo lokāyata-
mahāpurisalakkha-
ṇesu anavayo anuñ-

his own teacher with regard to the doctrine of the three knowledges: “Of that which I know, that you know, of that which you know, that I know.”

4. So then, the brahmin Pokkharasati addressed the brahmin youth Ambattha: “This samana Gotama, O my son Ambattha, son of the Sakyans, having gone forth from the Sakyan clan, while wandering on tour in Kosala with a large Sangha of bhikkhus, with about five hundred bhikkhus, has arrived at Icchanangala and is dwelling in the forest thicket of Icchanangala at Icchanangala. Now a good reputation has been spread about that Auspicious Gotama thus: “Truly is he the Auspicious One, the Arahant, rightly self-awakened, excelling in knowledge and conduct,

ñātapaṭiññāto sake ācariyake tevijjake pāvacane yamaḥ jānāmi taṃ tvaṃ jānāsi, yaṃ tvaṃ jānāsi tamahaṃ jānāmīti.

atha kho brāhmaṇo pokkharasāti ambaṭṭhaṃ māṇavaṃ āmantesi: “ayaṃ tāta ambaṭṭha samaṇo gotamo sakyaputto sakyakulā pabbajito kosalesu cārikaṃ caramāno mahatā bhikkhusaṅghena saddhiṃ pañcamattehi bhikkhusatehi icchānaṅgalam anuppatto icchānaṅgale viharati icchānaṅgalavanasaṇḍe. taṃ kho pana bhavantam gotamaṃ evaṃ kalayaṇo kittisaddo abbhuggato: “itipi so bhagavā, araham

well-farer, knower of worlds, incomparable charioteer of tamed persons, teacher of devas and humans, awakened, auspicious.” Having realized this world with its devas, maras and brahmas, together with the population of samanas and brahmanas, devas and humans, he causes to make it known. He teaches the Dhamma that is good in the beginning, good in the middle, good in the end, with the right meaning and phrasing, making known the life of purity that is utterly perfect and pure. Now good is the sight of such arahants.” Come you, my son Ambattha, visit with the samana Gotama. Having approached the samana Gotama, find out whether the good reputation spread about that good Gotama is really true as reported or not true, whether the good Gotama is just so, or whether he is not just so. In this way we will find out

sammāsambuddho -pe- brahmacariyaṃ pakāseti. sādhu kho pana tathārūpānaṃ arahataṃ dassanaṃ hotī”ti. ehi tvaṃ tāta ambatṭha, yena samaṇo gotamo tenu-pasaṅkama. upasaṅkamitvā samaṇaṃ gotamaṃ jānāhi yadi vā taṃ bhavantaṃ gotamaṃ tathāsaṇṭaṃyeva saddo abbhuggato, yadi vā no tathā, yadi vā so bhavaṃ gotamo tādiso, yadi vā na tādiso, tathā mayaṃ taṃ bhavantaṃ gotamaṃ vedissāmāti.

about that good Gotama.”

5. “But how can I sir, find out whether the good reputation spread about that good Gotama is really true as reported or not true, whether the good Gotama is just so, or whether he is not just so?”

6. “The thirty two auspicious marks of a great man, O my son Ambattha, has come down in our mantras, by which for the person endowed with those auspicious marks, there are only two destinies, no other. If he lives the home life, he becomes a wheel turning monarch, a righteous king ruling by the dhamma, victorious king of the world who has attained stability of the country, endowed with the seven gems.

“yathā katham panāham bho taṃ bhavantam gotamam jānissāmi yadi vā taṃ bhavantam gotamam tathāsantameva saddo abbhugato, yadi vā no tathā, yadi vā so bhavam gotamo tādiso yadi vā na tādiso”ti.

“āgatāni kho tāta ambattha, amhākaṃ mantesu dvattiṃsa mahāpurisalakkhaṇāni yehi samannāgatassa mahāpurissassa dveva gatiyo bhavanti anañña: sace agāraṃ ajjhāvasati rājā hoti cak-kavattī dhammiko dhammarājā cāturanto vijitāvī janapadattāvariyaṃ appatto sattaratanasamannāgato. tassimāni sat-

That is: The wheel gem, the elephant gem, the horse gem, the jewel gem, the woman gem, the head of household gem, with the counsellor gem as the seventh. He has more than a thousand sons who are courageous, heroic, crushing the armies of others. He dwells having conquered by the Dhamma this earth bounded by the ocean without rod, without sword. If however, he goes forth from the home life into homelessness, then he becomes an arahant, a supremely awakened one, who rolls back the veil in the world. But I, O my son Ambattha, am a giver of the mantras, you are the recipient of the mantras.” “Yes Master,” the brahmin youth Ambattha, having replied to the brahmin Pokkharasati, having risen up from his seat, having bowed down, having circumambulated the brahmin Pokkharasati, having mounted a mare-drawn

taratanāni bhavanti. seyyathidaṃ: cakkaratanam, hatthiratanam, assaratanam, maṇiratanam, itthiratanam, gahapatiratanam, parināyakaratanameva sattamam. parosahassam kho panassa puttā bhavanti sūrā viraṅgarūpā parasenappamaddanā. so imaṃ paṭhaviṃ sāgarapariyantaṃ adaṇḍena asatthena dhammena abhivijjiya ajjhāvasati. sace kho pana agārasmā anagāriyaṃ pabbajati araham hoti sammāsambuddho loke vivattacchado¹. aham kho pana tāta ambaṭṭha mantānam dātā tvam mantānam paṭiggahetā”ti. “evam bho’ti kho ambaṭṭho māṇavo brāhmaṇassa pokkhara-

chariot, set out to the forest thicket of icchanangala with many young brahmins. Having gone as far as the ground was suitable [for vehicles], having descended from the vehicle, he entered the monastery on foot.

7. At that time many bhikkhus were walking up and down in the open air. So then the brahmin youth Ambattha approached those bhikkhus. Having approached, he said this to those bhikkhus: “Where sirs, is the good Gotama dwelling at present? Indeed we have come here to see the good Gotama.”

sātissa paṭissutvā
uṭṭhāyāsanā brāhma-
ṇaṃ pokkharasātiṃ
abhivādetvā padak-
khiṇaṃ katvā vaḷavā-
rathamāruyha sam-
bahulehi māṇevahi¹
saddhiṃ yena icchā-
naṅgalavanasaṇḍo
tena pāyāsi. yāva-
tikā yānassa bhūmi
yānena gantvā yānā
paccorohitvā pat-
tiko’va ārāmaṃ pā-
visi.

tena kho pana sa-
mayena sambahulā
bhikkhū abbhokāse
caṅkamanti. atha
kho ambaṭṭho mā-
ṇavo yena te bhik-
khū tenupasaṅkami.
upasaṅkamitvā te
bhikkhū etadavoca:
“kahannu kho bho
etarahi so bhavaṃ
gotamo viharati?
taṃ hi mayaṃ bha-
vantāṃ gotamaṃ

8. Then this occurred to those bhikkhus: “This brahmin youth Ambattha is of a distinguished family and a well-known pupil of the brahmin Pokkharasati, and it is not troublesome for the Auspicious One to hold friendly conversation with such a son of good family.” They said this to the brahmin youth Ambattha: It is this dwelling with the closed door, O Ambattha. Approach it quietly without rush, and upon arrival, having entered the verandah, having cleared your throat, knock on the crossbar. The Auspicious One will open the door.

9. So then, the brahmin youth Ambattha, having ap-

dassanāya idhūpa-saṅkantā”ti.

atha kho tesam bhikkhūnaṃ etadahosi: “ayaṃ kho ambaṭṭho māṇavo abhiññāta-kolañño ceva abhiññātassa ca brāhmaṇassa pokkharasātissa antevāsī. agaru kho pana bhagavato evarūpehi kulaputtehi saddhiṃ kathāsallāpo hotī”ti. te ambaṭṭhaṃ māṇavaṃ etadavocaṃ: “eso ambaṭṭha vihāro saṃvutadvāro. tena appasaddo upasaṅkamitvā atarāmāno ālindaṃ pavisitvā ukkāsitvā aggaḷaṃ ākoṭehi. vivarissati te bhagavā dvāranti.”

atha kho ambaṭṭho māṇavo yena so vihāro saṃvutadvāro

proach the dwelling with the closed door quietly without rush, having entered the verandah, having cleared his throat, he knocked on the cross-bar. The Auspicious One opened the door. The brahmin youth Ambattha entered. The young brahmins too having entered, they exchanged friendly greetings with the Auspicious One. Having exchanged friendly greetings and cordial talk, they sat down to one side. However, the brahmin youth Ambattha, while walking back and forth, exchanged some friendly greetings or other with the Auspicious One being seated. While standing too, he exchanged some friendly greetings or other with the Auspicious One being seated.

10. Then the Auspicious One said this to the brahmin youth Ambattha: “Is that

tena appasaddo upa-
saṅkamitvā atara-
māno ālindaṃ pavi-
sitvā ukkāsitvā agga-
laṃ ākoṭesi. vivari
bhagavā dvāraṃ. pā-
visi ambattho mā-
ṇavo. māṇavakā’pi
pavisitvā bhagavatā
saddhiṃ sammo-
diṃsu. sammodanī-
yaṃ kathaṃ sārāṇī-
yaṃ vītisāretvā eka-
mantam nisīdiṃsu.
ambattho pana mā-
ṇavo caṅkamanto’pi
nisinnena bhaga-
vatā kañci kañci ka-
thaṃ sārāṇīyaṃ vī-
tisāreti. tthito’pi ni-
sinnena bhagavatā
kañci kañci kathaṃ
sārāṇīyaṃ vītisāreti.

atha kho bhagavā
ambattham māṇa-
vaṃ etadavoca: evaṇnu
kho te2 ambattha,

how you, O Ambattha, exchanged friendly greetings with brahmins who are aged, old men, teachers of teachers, just as you exchanged some friendly greetings or other with me sitting while you walk or stand?” “No indeed good Gotama. Indeed O good Gotama, it is suitable for a brahmin while walking, to converse with a brahmin who is walking. Indeed O good Gotama, it is suitable for a brahmin while standing, to converse with a brahmin who is standing. Indeed O good Gotama, it is suitable for a brahmin while sitting, to converse with a brahmin who is sitting. Indeed O good Gotama, it is suitable for a brahmin while lying down, to converse with a brahmin who is lying down. But with those bald-headed counterfeits samana, O good Gotama, dark out-castes, offsprings of our kinsmen’s feet, friendly greeting are exchanged with

brāhmaṇehi vud-dhehi mahallakehi ācariyapācariyehi saddhiṃ kathāsal-lāpo hoti yathayidaṃ caraṃ tiṭṭhaṃ nisin-nena mayā kañci kañci katham sārā-ṇīyaṃ vītisāretī?”ti “no hidaṃ bho gotama. gacchanto vā hi bho gotama gacchantena brāhmaṇo brāhmaṇena saddhiṃ sallapitumarahati. ṭhito vā hi bho gotama ṭhitenā brāhmaṇo brāhmaṇena saddhiṃ sallapitumarahati. nisinno vā hi bho gotama nisinnena brāhmaṇo brāhmaṇena saddhiṃ sallapitumarahati. sayāno vā hi bho gotama sayānena brāhmaṇo brāhmaṇena saddhiṃ sallapitumarahati. ye ca kho

them by me just as with the good Gotama.”

11. “But there was a purpose, O Ambattha, for you coming here. That very purpose for which you could come, it is just that purpose that you should pay close attention to. This brahmin youth Ambattha is immature though he conceives himself to be mature. What else could that be due to apart from immaturity.”

12. Then the brahmin youth Ambattha being called by the word, “immature,” by the Auspicious One, angry and displeased, really insulting the Auspicious One, really despising the Auspicious One,

te bho gotama muṇḍakā samaṇakā ibbhā kaṇhā² bandhupādāpaccā, tehipi me saddhiṃ evaṃ kathāsallāpo hoti yathariva bhotā gotamenā”ti.

“atthikavato kho pana te ambaṭṭha idhā-gamaṇaṃ ahosi. yāyeva kho panatthāya āgaccheyyātho tameva atthaṃ sādhu-kaṃ manasi kareyyātho¹. avusitavā yeva kho pana bho ayaṃ ambaṭṭho māṇavo vusitamānī² kimaññatra avusitattā”ti.

atha kho ambaṭṭho māṇavo bhagavatā avusitavādena vuc-camāno kupito anat-tamano bhagavan-taṃyeva khumsento bhagavantamāyeva

really criticizing the Auspicious One, [thinking]: “The good samana Gotama will suffer misfortune by me,” said this to the Auspicious One: “Wild, O good Gotama, are those of Sakyan birth.” “Rough, O good Gotama, are those of Sakyan birth.” “Touchy, O good Gotama, are those of Sakyan birth.” “Aggressive, O good Gotama, are those of Sakyan birth.” “Existing as subordinates, being subordinates, they neither honor the brahmins, nor esteem the brahmins, nor respect the brahmins, nor worship the brahmins, nor revere the brahmins. This, O good Gotama, is not pleasing, this is not proper, that these sakyans existing as subordinates, being subordinates, they neither honor the brahmins, nor esteem the brahmins, nor respect the brahmins, nor worship the brahmins, nor revere the brahmins.” Thus indeed, this

vambhento bhagavantamyeva upavadamāno samaṇo ca me bho gotamo pāpito bhavissatīti bhagavantam eta-davoca: “caṇḍā bho gotama sakyajāti, pharusā bho gotama sakyajāti, lahusā bho gotama sakyajāti, rabhasā bho gotama sakyajāti, ibbhā santā ibbhā samānā na brāhmaṇe sakkaronti na brāhmaṇe garukaronti na brāhmaṇe mānenti na brāhmaṇe pūjenti na brāhmaṇe apacāyanti. tayidaṃ bho gotama nacchannaṃ tayidaṃ nappaṭirūpaṃ yadime sakyā ibbhā santā ibbhā samānā na brāhmaṇe sakkaronti na brāhmaṇe garukaronti na brāhmaṇe mānenti na brāhmaṇe pūjenti

is the first [time] the brahmin youth Ambattha denigrated the Sakyans with the word, “subordinates.”

13. “But what, O Ambattha, did those Sakyans do wrong against you?” At this one time, O good Gotama, I arrived at Kapilavatthu just on some business for my teacher, the brahmin Pokkharasati. I approached the council hall of the Sakyans. At that time many Sakyans and Sakyan youths were just sitting on high seats in the council hall poking each other with their fingers, joking, playing together, I think they were most certainly only making fun of me. No one invited me to a seat. This, O good Gotama, is not pleasing, this is not proper, that these sakyans existing as subordinates, being subor-

na brāhmaṇe apacāyantīti. itiha ambatṭho māṇavo idaṃ paṭhamam sakkesu ibbhavādam nipātesi.

“kimpana te ambatṭha, sakyā aparaddhanti?” “eka midāham bho gotama, samayaṃ ācariyassa brāhmaṇassa pokkharasātissa kenacideva karaṇīyena kapilavatthum agamāsim. yena sakyānam santhāgāram tenupa-saṅkamim. tena kho pana samayena sambahulā sakyā ceva sakyakumārā ca santhāgāre uccesu āsanesu nisinnā honti aññamaññaṃ aṅgulipatodakehi saṅjagghantā saṃkīlantā aññadatthu mamaññaeva mañña anujagghantā. na maṃ

dinates, they neither honor the brahmins, nor esteem the brahmins, nor respect the brahmins, nor worship the brahmins, nor revere the brahmins.” Thus indeed, this is the second [time] the brahmin youth Ambattha denigrated the Sakyans with the word, “subordinates.”

14. “Even a quail bird, O Ambattha, says whatever she wants in her own nest. But this, O Ambattha, is the Sakyan’s own [home], that is Kapilavatthu. It is not worthy of the venerable Ambattha to abuse [the Sakyans] over such a trifle.”

koci āsanena’pi nimantesi. tayidaṃ bho gotama nacchanam, tayidaṃ napaṭirūpaṃ, yadime sakyā ibbhā santā ibbhā samānā na brāhmaṇe sakkaronti na brāhmaṇe garukaronti na brāhmaṇe mānenti na brāhmaṇe pūjenti na brāhmaṇe apacāyanti”ti. itiha ambatṭho māṇavo idaṃ dutiyaṃ sakkesu ibbhavādaṃ nipātesi.

“laṭukikāpi kho ambatṭha, sakuṇikā sake kulāvake kāmālāpinī hoti. sakaṃ kho panetaṃ ambaṭṭha sakyānaṃ yadidaṃ kapilavatthu. na arahatāyasmā ambatṭho imāya appamattāya abhisajjintuntī.”

15. There are, O good Gotama, these four castes: the Khattiya, the Brahmin, the Vessa and the Sudda. Of these four caste, O good Gotama, indeed the three castes, the Khattiyas, the Vessas and the Suddas are most certainly simply servants of the Brahmins. This, O good Gotama, is not pleasing, this is not proper, that these sakyans existing as subordinates, being subordinates, they neither honor the brahmins, nor esteem the brahmins, nor respect the brahmins, nor worship the brahmins, nor revere the brahmins.” Thus indeed, this is the third [time] the brahmin youth Ambattha denigrated the Sakyans with the word, “subordinates.”

16. Then of the Auspicious One this occurred: “This

“cattāro’me bho gotama, vaṇṇā: khattiyā brāhmaṇā vessā suddā. imesaṃ hi bho gotama catunnaṃ vaṇṇānaṃ tayo vaṇṇā khattiyā ca vessā ca suddā ca aññadatthu brāhmaṇasseva paricārakā sampajjanti. tadyidaṃ bho gotama nacchannaṃ tadyidaṃ nappaṭirūpaṃ yadi me sakyā ibbhā santā ibbhā samānā na brāhmaṇe sakkaronti na brāhmaṇe garukaronti na brāhmaṇe mānenti na brāhmaṇe pūjenti na brāhmaṇe apacāyanti”ti. itiha ambattho māṇavo idaṃ tatiyaṃ sakkesu ibbhavādaṃ nipātesi.

atha kho bhagavato etadahosi: atibālhaṃ kho ayaṃ am-

brahmin youth Ambattha denigrates the Sakyans too much with the word, “subordinates.” What if I were to ask about his clan?” So then, the Auspicious One said this to the brahmin youth, Ambattha: “What is you clan, O Ambattha?”

17. “I am a Kanhayana, good Gotama.”

18. “But O Ambattha, remembering the name and clan of your maternal and paternal ancestry, the Sakyans are the sons of the master, you are the son of a female slave of the Sakyans. The Sakyans, O Ambattha, regard king Okkaka as their paternal grandfather. Formally, O Ambattha, king Okkaka wishing to divert the kingdom to the son of his royal consort, dear and beloved, exiled the elder princes, Ukkamukha, Karakanda, Hatthinika and

baṭṭho māṇavo sakkesu ibbhavādena nimmāneti¹. yannūnāhaṃ gottamaṃ puccheyyanti. atha kho bhagavā ambaṭṭhaṃ māṇavaṃ etadavoca: ‘kathaṃ gottosi ambaṭṭhā?ti’

“kaṇhāyano’hamasmi, bho gotamā”ti.

“porāṇaṃ kho pana te ambaṭṭha mātāpettikaṃ nāmagottaṃ anussarato ayayaputtā sakyā bhavanti, dāsiputto tvaṃ masi sakyānaṃ. sakyā kho pana ambaṭṭha, rājānaṃ okkākaṃ pitāmahaṃ dahanti. “bhūtapubbaṃ ambaṭṭha, rājā okkāko yā sā mahesī piyā manāpā, tassā puttassa rajjaṃ pariṇāmetukāmo jeṭṭha-

Nipura from the country. Exiled from the country, at the bank of a pond on the slopes of the himalayan mountains, there they made their home in a large teak grove. For fear of contaminating their bloodline, they arranged mating with their own sisters. So then, O Ambattha, king Okkaka addressed a privy councillor of his assembly: “Where, good man, are the princes at present?” There is a bank of a pond on the slopes of the himalayan mountains, O king. There they have made their home in a large teak grove. For fear of contaminating their bloodline, they arranged mating with their own sisters. So then, O Ambattha, king Okkaka uttered and inspired utterance: “Certainly the holding of one’s own [sakya], Sir, hold the princes. Certainly the foremost holding of one’s own [paramasakya], Sir, hold the princes.” Hence-

kumāre ratthasmā pabbājesi ukkāmu-khaṃ² karaṇḍaṃ³ hatthinikaṃ nipuraṃ⁴. te ratthasmā pabbājita himavanta-passe pokkharaniyā tīre mahāsākaṇḍo tattha vasaṃ kap-pesum. te jātisambhedabhayā sakāhi bhaginīhi saddhiṃ saṃvāsaṃ kappesum. atha kho ambaṭṭha, rājā okkāko amacce pārisajje āmantesi: “kahannu kho bho etarahi kumārā sammantīti”? “atthi deva, himavanta-passe pokkharaniyā tīre mahāsākaṇḍo tatthetarahi kumārā sammantī. te jātisambhedabhayā sakāhi bhaginīhi saddhiṃ saṃvāsaṃ kappenti”^{ti}. atha kho ambaṭṭha, rājā okkāko udānaṃ

forth, O Ambattha, they were known as the Sakyans. Just he was their ancestor. But O ambatṭha, king Okkaka's female slave was named Dasi. She indeed gave birth to a black [baby]. The black baby spoke: "Wash me mother, bathe me mother, set me free from this filth mother, and I will be of benefit to you." Just as at present, O Ambattha, humans having seen a goblin, they recognize him as "A goblin." So too, O Ambattha, at that time, humans recognized goblins as "Black." They spoke thus: this baby speaks: "A black baby, a goblin baby." Henceforth, O Ambattha, they were known as the Kanhayanas. And he was the ancestor of the Kanhayanas. Thus, O Ambattha, remembering the name and clan of your maternal and paternal ancestry, the Sakyans are the sons of the master, you are the son of a female slave of the Sakyans."

udānesi: "sakyā vata bho kumārā para-masakyā vata bho kumārā"ti. tadagge kho pana ambatṭha, sakyā paññāyanti. so'va¹ nesam pubba-puriso. rañño ca kho pana ambatṭha, ok-kākassa disā nāma dāsī ahosi. sā kaṇ-haṃ² nāma janesi. jāto kaṇho pabyā-hāsi: "dhovatha maṃ amma, nahāpetha maṃ amma, imasmā maṃ amma asucismā parimocetha, atthāya vo bhavissāmī'ti. ya-thā kho pana am-batṭha, etarahi ma-nussā pisāce disvā 'pisācā'ti sañjānanti. evameva kho am-batṭha, tena sama-yena manussā pi-sāce 'kaṇhā'ti sañ-jānanti. te evamā-hamsu: ayaṃ jāto pabyāhāsi: 'kaṇho

19. When thus was said, those young brahmins said this to the Auspicious One: “Let not the good Gotamo disgrace the brahmin youth Ambattha too much, with the use of the words: “The son of a female slave.” Well-born, O good Gotama, is the brahmin youth Ambattha, and son of a good family is the brahmin youth Ambattha, and of great learning is the brahmin youth Ambattha, and eloquent is the brahmin youth Ambattha, and wise

jāto, pisāco jāto’ti. tadagge kho pana ambaṭṭha, kaṇhāyanā paññāyanti. so ca kaṇhāyanānaṃ pubbapuriso. iti kho te ambaṭṭha, porāṇaṃ mātāpettikaṃ nāmagottaṃ anussarato ayyaputtā sakyā bhavanti. dāsiputto tvamasi sakyānanti.

evaṃ vutte te māṇava-kā bhagavantaṃ etadavocaṃ: “mā bhavaṃ gotamo ambaṭṭhaṃ māṇavaṃ atibālhaṃ dāsiputtavādena nimmānesi. sujāto ca bho gotama, ambaṭṭho māṇavo kulaputto ca ambaṭṭho māṇavo bahussuto ca ambaṭṭho māṇavo kalayānavākkaraṇo ca ambaṭṭho māṇavo paṇḍito ca ambaṭṭho māṇavo. pahoti ca

is the brahmin youth Ambattha, and the brahmin youth Ambattha is capable of discussing this matter with the good Gotama.”

20. Then the Auspicious One said this to those young brahmins: “If it occurs to you, O young brahmins thus: “Ill-born is the brahmin youth Ambattha, and not son of a good family is the brahmin youth Ambattha, and of little learning is the brahmin youth Ambattha, and ineloquent is the brahmin youth Ambattha, and unwise is the brahmin youth Ambattha, and the brahmin youth Ambattha is not capable of discussing this matter with the good Gotama,” then let the brahmin youth Ambattha, stand aside, and you all discuss the matter with me. If however, it occurs to you young brahmins thus: “Well-born, O good Gotama, is the

ambattho māṇavo bhotā gotamena saddhiṃ asmiṃ vacane paṭimantetu”nti.

atha kho bhagavā te māṇavake etada-voca: “sace kho tumhākaṃ māṇavakā evaṃ hoti ‘dujjāto ca ambattho māṇavo, akulaputto ca ambattho māṇavo, appassuto ca ambattho māṇavo, akal-yāṇavākkaraṇo ca ambattho māṇavo, duppañño ca ambattho māṇavo, na ca pahoti ambattho māṇavo samaṇena gotamena saddhiṃ asmiṃ vacane paṭimantetunti, tiṭṭhatu ambattho māṇavo, tumhe mayā saddhiṃ mantayavho1 asmiṃ vacane. sace pana tumhākaṃ mā-

brahmin youth Ambattha, and son of a good family is the brahmin youth Ambattha, and of great learning is the brahmin youth Ambattha, and eloquent is the brahmin youth Ambattha, and wise is the brahmin youth Ambattha, and the brahmin youth Ambattha is capable of discussing this matter with the good Gotama,” then you all stand aside, and let the brahmin youth Ambattha, discuss the matter with me.”

21. “Well-born, O good Gotama, is the brahmin youth Ambattha, and son of a good family is the brahmin youth Ambattha, and of great learning is the brahmin youth Ambattha, and eloquent is the brahmin youth Ambattha, and wise is brahmin youth Ambattha, and the brahmin

navakā evaṃ hoti: sujāto ca ambaṭṭho māṇavo, kulaputto ca ambaṭṭho māṇavo, bahussuto ca ambaṭṭho māṇavo, kal-yāṇavākkaraṇo ca ambaṭṭho māṇavo, paṇḍito ca ambaṭṭho māṇavo, pahoti ca ambaṭṭho māṇavo samaṇena gotamena saddhiṃ asmim vacane paṭimantetunti, tiṭṭhatha tumhe, ambaṭṭho māṇavo mayā saddhiṃ paṭimantetū”ti.

“sujāto ca bho gotama ambaṭṭho māṇavo, kulaputto ca ambaṭṭho māṇavo, bahussuto ca ambaṭṭho māṇavo, kal-yāṇavākkaraṇo ca ambaṭṭho māṇavo, paṇḍito ca ambaṭṭho māṇavo, pahoti ca ambaṭṭho māṇavo

youth Ambattha is capable of discussing this matter with the good Gotama,” We will be silent. The brahmin youth Ambattha, is to discuss this matter with the good Gotama.”

22. Then the Auspicious One said this to the brahmin youth Ambattha: “This legitimate question, O Ambattha comes for you. Even if you do not like it, it should be answered. If you do not answer, or respond with a different topic, or will become silent, or go away, your head will split into seven pieces right here. So what do you think, O Ambattha? What have you heard said by brahmins of old, of ancient times, teachers of teachers, speaking about the origin of the Kanhayanas, about who was the ancestor of the Kanhayanas?” When thus was said, the brah-

bhotā gotamena sad-dhiṃ asmiṃ vacane paṭimantetuṃ. tuṇhī mayaṃ bhavissāma. ambaṭṭho māṇavo bhotā gotamena sad-dhiṃ asmiṃ vacane paṭimantetū”ti.

atha kho bhagavā ambaṭṭhaṃ māṇavaṃ etadavoca: ayaṃ kho pana te ambaṭṭha, sahadhammiko pañho āgacchati. akāmāpi vyākātabbo. sace tvaṃ na vyākarissasi aññena vā aññaṃ paṭicarissasi, tuṇhī vā bhavissasi, pakkamissasi vā ettheva te sattadhā muddhā phalissati. taṃ kiṃ maññasi ambaṭṭha? kinti te sutam brāhmaṇaṇaṃ vuddhānaṃ mahallakānaṃ ācariya-pācariyānaṃ bhāsa-mānānaṃ kutopa-

min youth Ambattha became silent. Also for a second time, the Auspicious One said this to the brahmin youth Ambattha: “So what do you think, O Ambattha? What have you heard said by brahmins of old, of ancient times, teachers of teachers, speaking about the origin of the Kanhayanas, about who was the ancestor of the Kanhayanas?” Also for a second time, the brahmin youth Ambattha became silent. So then the Auspicious One said this to the brahmin youth Ambattha: “Answer now, O Ambattha. Now is not the appropriate time for your silence. He who does not answer a legitimate question from the Tathagata, O Ambattha, up to the third time [asking], his head will split into seven pieces right here.”

bhutikā kaṇhāyanā?
ko ca kaṇhāyanānaṃ
pubbapuriso?ti evaṃ
vutte ambaṭṭho mā-
ṇavo tuṇhī ahosi. du-
tiyampi kho bhagavā
ambaṭṭhaṃ māṇa-
vaṃ etadavoca: taṃ
kimmāññasi ambaṭ-
ṭha? kinti te sutāṃ
brāhmaṇānaṃ vud-
dhānaṃ mahallakā-
naṃ -pe- ko ca kaṇ-
hāyanānaṃ pubba-
puriso?ti dutiyampi
kho ambaṭṭho mā-
ṇavo tuṇhī ahosi.
atha kho bhagavā
ambaṭṭhaṃ māṇa-
vaṃ etadavoca: vyā-
karohi ‘dāni ambaṭ-
ṭha, na’ dāni te tuṇ-
hībhāvassa kālo. yo
kho ambaṭṭha tathā-
gatena yāvatatiya-
kaṃ sahadhammi-
kaṃ pañhaṃ puttṭho
na vyākaroti etthe-
vassa sattadhā mud-
dhā phalissati.

23. On that occasion the yakkha Vajirapani taking a huge iron hammer that was in flames, burning, blazing, was standing in the air above the brahmin youth Ambattha [thinking]: “If this brahmin youth Ambattha does not answer a legitimate question from the Auspicious One up to the third time [asking], I will split his head into seven pieces right here.” But only the Auspicious One and the brahmin youth Ambattha [could] see the yakkha Vajirapani.

24. Then the brahmin youth Ambattha being frightened, moved by fear, with hairs standing on end, seeking shelter from the Auspicious One, seeking protection from the Auspicious One, seeking

tena kho pana samayena vajirapāṇi yakkho mahantaṃ ayo-kūṭaṃ ādāya āditaṃ sampajjalitaṃ sajotibhūtaṃ ambaṭṭhassa māṇavassa uparivehāsaṃ ṭhito hoti: sacāyaṃ ambaṭṭho māṇavo bhagavatā yāvatatiya-kam sahadhammi-kam pañhaṃ puṭṭho na vyākarissati, ethevassa satta-dhā muddhaṃ phālessāmīti. taṃ kho pana vajirapāṇiṃ yakkhaṃ bhagavā ceva passati ambaṭṭho ca māṇavo.

atha kho ambaṭṭho māṇavo bhīto saṃviggo lomahaṭṭhājāto bhagavantaṃ yeva tāṇagavesi bhagavantaṃ yeva leṇagavesi bhagavantaṃ yeva saraṇagavesi

refuge from the Auspicious One, sitting closer to the Auspicious One said this to the Auspicious One: “What is it that the good Gotama said to me? May the good Gotama say it again?” “So what do you think, O Ambattha? What have you heard said by brahmins of old, of ancient times, teachers of teachers, speaking about the origin of the Kanhayanas, about who was the ancestor of the Kanhayanas?” “So too has been heard by me, good Gotama, just as the good Gotama has said. that is the origin of the Kanhayanas, and he was the ancestor of the Kanhayanas.”

25. When thus was said those young brahmins became noisy, making a great noise, a loud noise [saying]: “Apparently, Sir, the brahmin

upanisīditvā bhagavantam etadavoca: “kim me tam bhavam gotamo āha? puna bhavam gotamo bravītū”ti. “tam kim-maññasi ambatṭha? kinti te sutam brāhmaṇānam vuddhānam mahallakānam ācariyapācariyānam bhāsamānānam, kuttoppabhutikā kaṇhāyanā? ko ca kaṇhāyanānam pubbapuriso?ti.” “evameva me bho gotama sutam, yatheva bhavam gotamo āha. ta-toppabhutikā kaṇhāyanā. so ca kaṇhāyanānam pubbapuriso”ti.

evam vutte te māṇavakā unnādino uc-cāsaddamahāsaddā ahesum: “dujjāto kira bho ambatṭho māṇavo, akulaputto

youth Ambattha is ill-born. Apparently, Sir, the brahmin youth Ambattha is not a son of a good family. Apparently, Sir, the brahmin youth Ambattha is a son of a female slave of the Sakyans. Apparently, Sir, the Sakyans are the sons of the master of the brahmin youth Ambattha. apparently the samana Gotama speaks just the truth, [yet] we presumed he should be disparaged.”

26. So then of the Auspicious One this occurred: “These young brahmins disgrace the brahmin youth ambattha too much with the use of the words: “The son of a female slave.” What if I were to set him free.” So then the Auspicious One said this to those young brahmins: “Let not you young brahmins disgrace the brahmin youth ambattha too much with the use of the words: “The son

kira bho ambattho māṇavo, dāsiputto kira bho ambattho māṇavo sakyānaṃ, ayyaputtā kira bho ambatthassa māṇavassa sakyā bhavanti. dhammavādiṃ yeva kira mayā samaṇaṃ gotamaṃ apasādetabbaṃ amaññimhā”ti.

atha kho bhagavato etadahosi: “atibālhaṃ kho ime māṇavakā ambatthaṃ māṇavaṃ dāsiputtavādena nimmānenti. yannūnāhaṃ parimoceyyanti.” atha kho bhagavā te māṇavake etadavoca: “mā kho tumhe māṇavakā ambatthaṃ māṇavaṃ atibālhaṃ dāsiputtavādena nimmānetha. ulāro

of a female slave.” Mighty was Kanha, the seer. He, having gone to the southern country, having learnt by heart the mantra of the brahmins, having approached king Okkaka, he asked for his daughter Mattharupi in marriage. King Okkaka [saying] Unbelievable! Who, being just the son of my female slave, would ask for my daughter Mattharupi in marriage.” Being angry and displeased, he drew [a bow with] a razor-tipped arrow. He was just unable to either release that razor-tipped arrow nor withdraw it. So then, O young brahmins, the privy councillors of his assembly, having approached Kanha, the seer, said this: “Let there be safety for the king, O venerable sir. Let there be safety for the king, O venerable sir.” “There will be safety for the king. But if the king were to release the razor-tipped arrow downwards, then the

so kaṇho isi ahosi.
so dakkhiṇaṃ janapadaṃ gantvā
brahme mante adhī-
yitvā rājānaṃ okkā-
kaṃ upasaṅkamtivā
maṭṭharūpiṃ¹ dhī-
taraṃ yāci. tassa
rājā okkāko ‘ko neva
re ayaṃ mayhaṃ
dāsiputto samāno
maṭṭharūpiṃ dhīta-
raṃ yācatī’ti kupito
anattamano khurappaṃ
sannayhi.
so taṃ khurappaṃ
neva asakkhi muñ-
cituṃ, no paṭisaṃ-
harituṃ. atha kho
māṇavakā amaccā
pārisajjā kaṇhaṃ
isiṃ upasaṅkamtivā
etadavocuṃ: “so-
tthi bhadante hotu
rañño, sotthi bha-
dante hotu rañño”ti.
“sotthi bhavissati
rañño, api ca rājā
yadi adho khurap-
paṃ muñcissati yā-

earth will split open as far as his kingdom extends.” “Let there be safety for the king, O venerable sir. Let there be safety for the country, O venerable sir.” “There will be safety for the king. There will be safety for the country. But if the king were to release the razor-tipped arrow upwards, then the [rain] Deva will not rain for seven years as far as his kingdom extends.” “Let there be safety for the king, O venerable sir. Let there be safety for the country, O venerable sir, and let the [rain] Deva rain.” “There will be safety for the king. There will be safety for the country, and the [rain] Deva will rain. But if the king were to shoot the razor-tipped arrow at his eldest son, the prince will be safe. The prince will not be harmed.” So then, O young brahmins, king Okkaka’s privy counsellors addressed [him saying]: O king, shoot the razor-tipped

vatā rañño vijitaṃ ettāvatā paṭhavī udriyissatī”ti. “sothhi bhadante hotu rañño, sothhi janapadassā”ti. “sothhi bhavissati rañño, sothhi janapadassa. api ca rājā yadi uddhaṃ khurappaṃ muñcissati yāvatā rañño vijitaṃ ettāvatā sattavas-sāni devo na vassissatī”ti. “sothhi bhadante hotu rañño, sothhi janapadassa, devo ca vassatū”ti. “sothhi bhavissati rañño, sothhi janapadassa, devo ca vassissati. api ca rājā jeṭṭhakumāre khurappaṃ patiṭṭhāpetu, sothhi kumāro, pallo mo bhavissatī”ti. atha kho māṇavakā, amaccā okkākassa ārocesuṃ: “devo jeṭṭhakumāre khurappaṃ patiṭṭhāpetu,

arrow at your eldest son. The prince will be safe. The prince will not be harmed. So king Okkaka shot the razor-tipped arrow at his eldest son. The prince was safe. The prince was not harmed. So then being frightened, moved by fear, with hairs standing on end, fearing the disfavor of the gods, king Okkaka gave his daughter. Let not you young brahmins disgrace the brahmin youth ambattha too much with the use of the words: “The son of a female slave.” Mighty was Kanha, the seer.”

sotthi kumāro pal-
lomo bhavissatī”ti.
atha kho rājā okkāko
jeṭṭhakumāre khu-
rappam patitṭhāpesi.
sotthi kumāro pal-
lomo bhavi. atha
kho tassa rājā ok-
kāko bhīto samviggo
lomahatṭhajāto brah-
maṇḍaṇa tājito
maṭṭharūpiṃ dhīta-
ram adāsi. mā kho
tumhe māṇavakā
ambatṭham māṇa-
vaṃ atibālham dā-
siputtavādena nim-
mānetha. ulāro so
kaṇho isi ahosi.

